

Blue Advantage Pharmacy Benefit Management

Carelon Health - Prior Authorization Determination Notice

NOTICE: REQUEST FOR PRIOR AUTHORIZATION - DENIED

Member Name: Jordan Ellison

Member ID: MEM-0004821

Group Number: 60492-A

Date of Notice: March 12, 2026

Reference Number: PA-2026-0338471

Medication Requested: Semaglutide 1 mg injection (GLP-1 Agonist, Tier 4)

Prescriber: Dr. Marcus Chen, MD (NPI 1487302596)

Prescribing Practice: Peachtree Endocrinology Associates, Atlanta, GA

Diagnosis on File: E11.9 - Type 2 diabetes mellitus without complications

Most Recent HbA1c on File: 7.9% (February 2026)

Step Therapy Status: Not satisfied

DETERMINATION: DENIED

Denial Reason:

The request for Semaglutide 1 mg does not meet the plan's coverage criteria. Per Section 2.1 of the Blue Advantage Formulary Guidelines (FORM-2026-001), GLP-1 agonists require documentation of a failed 90-day trial of at least two formulary alternatives at therapeutic dose, including Metformin plus one other oral antidiabetic agent. Pharmacy claims history shows a 45-day supply of Metformin ER 750 mg filled November 2025 through December 2025 with no additional fills, and no trial of a second oral agent. The member's HbA1c of 7.9% does not satisfy the requirement of 7.5% or above on two consecutive readings. Step therapy requirements are not waived for member convenience.

Appeal Rights:

You or your prescriber may appeal this determination within 60 calendar days of the date of this notice. The appeal deadline for this denial is May 11, 2026. A Level 1 appeal must include clinical documentation of medical necessity. Standard appeals are decided within 30 calendar days; urgent appeals within 72 hours. Your prescriber may also request a peer-to-peer review with the medical director, which does not extend the appeal deadline. If the Level 1 appeal is upheld, you may request an independent external review by the state Department of Insurance within 4 months.

Alternative Options:

Coverage may be reconsidered upon completion of a documented 90-day trial of Metformin plus one additional formulary oral antidiabetic (options include Glipizide, Sitagliptin, or Empagliflozin), with HbA1c reassessment at the end of the trial period. Your prescriber can submit a new PA request with the updated clinical documentation.

Questions: Call the number on your member ID card or contact Pharmacy Benefit Management.

This notice is a synthetic document created for training purposes and contains no real